

- (c) Nepal, Pakistan, Bangladesh, China
(d) Pakistan, Nepal, China, Bangladesh

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

The length of the international border (land border) with the neighbouring countries of India is as follows :

Country	Length of border (in km)
Bangladesh	4096.7
China	3488
Pakistan	3323
Nepal	1751
Myanmar	1643
Bhutan	699
Afghanistan	106
Total	15,106.7

Therefore, according to the question, the ascending order is - Nepal, Pakistan, China, and Bangladesh.

28. India's territorial limit extends towards the sea up to how many nautical miles/km from the coast?

- (a) 10 nautical miles (about 19.9 km)
(b) 16 nautical miles (about 25.9 km)
(c) 12 nautical miles (about 21.9 km)
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

India's territorial limit extends towards the up to 12 nautical miles (about 22.2 km) from the coast. Significantly, the mainland of India, extends from Kashmir in the north to Kanniyakumari in the south and Arunachal Pradesh in the east to Gujarat in the west. India's southern boundary extends up to 6° 45'N latitude in the Bay of Bengal. The actual distance measured from north to south is 3214 km and that of east to west is only 2933 km.

29. Which district of Uttarakhand is not situated along the Tibet boundary?

- (a) Uttarkashi (b) Chamoli
(c) Almora (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre), 2023

Ans. (c)

Almora district of Uttarakhand is not situated along the Tibet boundary. Significantly, three districts of Uttarakhand share a border with Tibet-Chamoli, Pithoragarh and Uttarkashi.

2. Physical Divisions

i. Natural Regions of India

*Paleomagnetism is the branch that studies the magnetic properties preserved in the rocks, sediments or other such things during their formation. This branch of science is helpful in the study of ancient geological phenomena. **According to continental drift theory, the Indian mainland is a part of Gondwanaland.** Gondwanaland includes present day Peninsular India, Australia, Africa, Arabian Peninsula, South America and regions of Antarctica. *In the mid Mesozoic era (Jurassic Period, 144-208 Million Years Ago), Gondwanaland split into a number of pieces through convection currents. The Indian plate started drifting towards north after splitting from Gondwanaland. Consequently, the Indian plate, moving towards north, collided with a bigger plate, called the Eurasian plate.

Due to this collision, the sedimentary rocks of the Tethys Sea, between the two plates (i.e., Indian and Eurasian), folded and developed into the Himalayas and mountain ranges of West Asia. The whole mountain range of the Himalayas represents a youthful topography. It has high peaks, deep valleys (gorges), and fast-flowing rivers. In the Terai region of the Himalayas, **artesian wells** are also found.

*Due to upliftment of **Tethys Sea** in the Himalayas and the subsidence of the northern flank of the peninsular plateau, resulted in the formation of a large basin. With the passage of time, this basin was gradually filled with sedimentary deposits of rivers flowing from Northern mountains and Peninsular Plateau. In this way, a vast land area of alluvial deposits was developed as the 'Northern Plain' of India.

*Geologically, Peninsular Plateau is the ancient part of Earth's surface. *Peninsular Plateau is the most stable region of India. Peninsular Plateau comprises of hills and broad valleys which are made up of igneous and metamorphic rocks. Meghalaya plateau is an extension of Peninsular plateau. It was separated from Indian Peninsula through **Malda Gap** due to faulting. The Western Coast of India was formed due to faulting and subsidence of the western flank of the plateau.

*The Indian mainland shows a large variation in the physical structure. Therefore India is divided into four natural regions. These are - 1. Northern Mountains 2. Northern Plains 3. Peninsular Plateau and 4. Coastal Plains & Islands. *Based on the variations in its geological structure and formations,